Thailand
November 2026

1 – 14 NOVEMBER 2026

Bangkok · Chiang Mai · Krabi · Khao Sok · Bangkok
14 days, 13 nights, two travellers

Trip summary

November 1 — Sunday

BANGKOK

- Sawatdee khrap — welcome to Thailand
- EK374 arrives 07:35
- Airport to the hotel by rail
- Check in — The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok
- Use The Edit benefits — this stay only
- Wat Pho
- Manohra dining cruise — 20:00, booked
- Confirm the boarding time — and it is a late night

November 2 — Monday

BANGKOK

- Grand Palace & Wat Phra Kaew
- Wat Arun
- Optional — Jim Thompson House
- Yaowarat after dark
- The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok

November 3 — Tuesday

BANGKOK → THE NIGHT TRAIN

- Optional — Floating market, or a food tour — not both
- Ask for late check-out
- Special Express #9 — 18:40 to Chiang Mai

November 4 — Wednesday

CHIANG MAI

- Arrive Chiang Mai 07:15
- Check in — U Chiang Mai
- The Old City on foot
- Wat Phra That Doi Suthep — this afternoon or not at all
- Night Bazaar and khao soi

November 5 — Thursday

CHIANG MAI

- Doi Inthanon private tour — 08:30, booked
- Two things TripGuru needs from you first
- Nimman in the evening
- U Chiang Mai

November 6 — Friday

CHIANG MAI

- Elephant Nature Park — Elephant Highlands, booked
- THB 8,400 in cash, on the morning
- Confirm the pick-up point 72 hours ahead
- It is a walking day, and a muddy one
- Repack tonight

November 7 — Saturday

KRABI

- FD3072 — Chiang Mai 07:55 → Krabi 09:55
- Krabi airport to Ao Nang
- Check in — Centara Ao Nang Beach Resort & Spa
- First Andaman sunset

November 8 — Sunday

KRABI

- Island-hopping — not booked
- The most weather-dependent day of the trip
- Reef-safe sunscreen

November 9 — Monday

KRABI

- Optional — Tiger Cave Temple at sunrise
- Optional — Emerald Pool & hot springs
- Long drive tomorrow

November 10 — Tuesday

KHAO SOK

- Leave Krabi by 09:00
- Longtail across Cheow Lan Lake — 12:00
- THB 340 each, in cash
- Check in — 360° Issara Floating Resort
- Wildlife safari & sunset cruise — 17:00

November 11 — Wednesday

KHAO SOK

- Pakarang Cave Trail — 09:45
- Then nothing at all

November 12 — Thursday

KHAO SOK

- Morning on the lake
- Prakai Petch Cave Trail — confirm this one
- Last sunset cruise — 17:00
- Pack tonight

November 13 — Friday

KHAO SOK → BANGKOK

Check out 10:00, boat out at 10:30

Chiew Larn to Surat Thani

SL741 — Surat Thani 16:40 → Don Mueang 17:55

Into the city by rail, not road

Check in — Grande Centre Point Terminal 21

November 14 — Saturday

BANGKOK → HOME

A half day, not a full one

Leave by 17:00 — and mind the airport

EK373 — 20:45 to Dubai, then JFK

Chok dee

Information & documents

Everything below is either a number you might need in a hurry or a thing that is easy to forget on the day. The day-by-day pages follow.

Using this document

Keep it on your phone; you do not need to print the confirmations. Your name and the confirmation number are enough at every hotel. Every booking reference in this document also appears on the published itinerary at the download link, so either will do at a desk.

Emergency numbers — Thailand

All emergencies	`191`
Medical / ambulance	`1669`
Tourist police	`1155` — English-speaking

Suppliers

For anything urgent on the day, call the operator directly rather than the agent — it is faster.

360° Issara	`+66 2 474 0360`
Thai Lion Air	`+66 2 529 9999`
Chase Travel	`1-855-234-2542` — Ritz-Carlton, U Chiang Mai, Centara
Elephant Nature Park	`+66 53 272855` — 07:00–17:00 daily
TripGuru	`+1 254 454 4878` — WhatsApp chat, Doi Inthanon tour
Manohra Cruises	`+66 2 476 0022`

Travel insurance

Berkshire Hathaway Travel Protection, policy `201350715`, purchased 21 July 2026 and covering this trip. This is the replacement policy issued with the correct number of flight segments, so it is the one to quote. The full document is in the trip email thread.

Weather and conditions

Early November is the front edge of the cool, dry season, but it is a front edge rather than a guarantee. The Andaman is still drying out — expect a wet afternoon or two around Krabi, and treat the island-hopping day as the one to move. Khao Sok is at its lushest precisely because the rain has only just stopped. Sea state is the thing that cancels boat trips, so ask at the hotel desk the evening before rather than the morning of.

Cash

Card works nearly everywhere, but three things on this trip are cash-only. The big one is in Chiang Mai: the **THB 8,400 balance for Elephant Nature Park**, payable in Thai baht on the morning of the 6th. Draw it on the 5th. The other two are at Khao Sok: the national park fee of **THB 340 per person** on arrival and **THB 200 each** for the Pakarang cave trail — draw those before you leave Krabi, as there is no ATM on the lake.

Still to book

Every night and every flight is confirmed, and so are three activities: the Manohra dinner cruise on the 1st, the Doi Inthanon tour on the 5th and Elephant Nature Park on the 6th. What is left is all in the south, and all of it can be arranged locally: the island-hopping boat on the 8th, Tiger Cave or the Emerald Pool on the 9th, and the two cave trails at Khao Sok — though the cave trails have fixed departure times and run only on certain days.

Day by day

November 1 — Sunday

BANGKOK

Sawatdee khrap — welcome to Thailand

You land at Suvarnabhumi after roughly 21 hours in transit and a 12-hour time shift. Take it gently; the day is built to be abandoned if you need to sleep.

EK374 arrives 07:35

Dubai → Bangkok Suvarnabhumi (BKK), Airbus A380. Booking reference `H2M5FJ`.

Airport to the hotel by rail

Clear immigration, then follow the signs down to the **Airport Rail Link** on the basement level of the terminal. Three steps, about 45–50 minutes in total, roughly THB 65 each:

1. City Line towards Phaya Thai, alighting at **Makkasan** (A6) — about 25 minutes, THB 35. Buy a token at the machine or tap a contactless card.

2. Follow the **166 m covered skywalk** from Makkasan to **MRT Phetchaburi** — five minutes, longer with cases.

3. MRT Blue Line towards **Hua Lamphong**, four stops: Sukhumvit, Queen Sirikit, Khlong Toei, **Lumphini**. Leave by **Exit 1**, which feeds a walkway into One Bangkok; the hotel is inside it, about 300 m from the door — noticeably better with cases than walking from Ploen Chit. A taxi is 45 to 90 minutes depending on the expressway.

Check in — The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok

Confirmation `90034653` · 2 nights · Deluxe Room, 1 King, Park View. Standard check-in is 15:00, but early check-in is one of your Edit benefits — ask at the desk. If the room isn't ready, leave the bags and start the day anyway.

Use The Edit benefits — this stay only

Booking through The Edit includes **breakfast for two daily**, a **USD 100 property credit** (once per stay, not against room rate, tax or gratuities), a welcome amenity, Wi-Fi, and a room upgrade plus early check-in and late check-out, all subject to availability. None of it is applied automatically — ask for each. U Chiang Mai and Centara were booked through Chase Travel too, but neither carries these.

Wat Pho

The reclining Buddha, 46 m of gilded plaster, and the country's oldest centre of massage teaching. A foot massage at the temple's own school is the correct way to spend the first afternoon.

Manohra dining cruise — 20:00, booked

Reservation `YQGNYS` · two people · prepaid THB 11,000, **non-refundable**. A converted teak rice barge from the Anantara Riverside pier on the Thonburi bank, up the Chao Phraya past **Wat Arun** and the Grand Palace lit from the water. Premium set menu with free-flow wine and beer. Getting there: MRT Lumphini → Si Lom, cross to BTS Sala Daeng → Saphan Taksin, then the free Anantara shuttle boat from Sathorn pier every 15 minutes — about an hour door to door, so leave by 18:00 and be at the pier by 19:00.

Confirm the boarding time — and it is a late night

The reservation reads 20:00, but Manohra's published cruise departs 19:30 with check-in from 19:15; you are booked on the "Third Round" seating, so the times may differ. Settle it when you call about dietary requirements — `riversidedining@anantara.com` or 02 476 0022. Back at the hotel around 23:00, after 21 hours of travelling across a 12-hour shift. Keep the afternoon soft; this is the one fixed point of the day.

November 2 — Monday

BANGKOK

Grand Palace & Wat Phra Kaew

Be there at opening. The Emerald Buddha sits in the royal chapel; the complex is the single most crowded thing you will do all fortnight, and the heat compounds it. Shoulders and knees covered.

Wat Arun

Cross by ferry. Climb the central prang for the view back over the river.

Optional — Jim Thompson House

Six teak houses assembled by the American who rebuilt the Thai silk trade and then vanished in the Malaysian jungle in 1967. A cool, shaded hour.

Yaowarat after dark

Chinatown's street-food stretch. Go hungry and eat standing up.

The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok

Second night. Breakfast for two is included — it is an Edit benefit, not a room-rate inclusion, so mention it.

November 3 — Tuesday

BANGKOK → THE NIGHT TRAIN

Optional — Floating market, or a food tour — not both

The **Maeklong railway market** and **Damnoen Saduak** are 80–100 km southwest and the market is finished by late morning, so those half-days leave the city around 06:30. If that's too early after two days of jet lag, take a slow morning and a guided food tour instead.

Ask for late check-out

An Edit benefit, and worth claiming: a shower before thirteen hours in a sleeper berth is not nothing. Pack an overnight bag you can actually reach from the berth.

Special Express #9 — 18:40 to Chiang Mai

Krung Thep Aphiwat (KTW) 18:40 → Chiang Mai (CGM) 07:15 next morning. Roughly 13 hours, 751 km. Two 2nd-class A/C sleeper berths, reservation `34511470`, e-tickets issued. **Be at the station by 18:10.** Dinner in the dining car, then berths down.

November 4 — Wednesday

CHIANG MAI

Arrive Chiang Mai 07:15

Thirteen hours north and about six degrees cooler.

Check in — U Chiang Mai

Confirmation `2535552787` · Deluxe with Bathtub, 1 King, inside the moat. **The room is held from the 3rd**, the night you were on the train — paid deliberately so it is yours the moment you step off the sleeper, whatever the train does. Non-refundable. Breakfast is extra, about **THB 399** each.

The Old City on foot

Wat Chedi Luang, whose 15th-century chedi lost its top thirty metres to an earthquake, and **Wat Phra Singh**. The quiet lanes between the two are the actual pleasure.

Wat Phra That Doi Suthep — this afternoon or not at all

The gold chedi on the mountain above the city, reached by 306 steps flanked by naga balustrades. An hour up, an hour back. **The 5th and 6th are now both full-day booked tours**, so this afternoon is the only slot it has left.

Night Bazaar and khao soi

The north's signature dish: egg noodles in a coconut curry broth, crisp noodles on top, pickled mustard greens and lime alongside.

November 5 — Thursday

CHIANG MAI

Doi Inthanon private tour — 08:30, booked

Tripadvisor reference `1444673351`, TripGuru reference `7E51T410N0DP` · two adults · USD 250 paid in full. Thailand's highest peak, the waterfalls and the twin royal chedis, as a private full-day tour with an English-speaking guide. Hotel pick-up and drop-off, air-conditioned vehicle, drinking water and the entrance fees (Doi Inthanon THB 300, Twin Pagoda THB 100) are all included. **Lunch is not.** Free cancellation up to 24 hours before.

Two things TripGuru needs from you first

1. Your WhatsApp number and the hotel name, sent before **18:00 the day before** — miss that and they collect you at a meeting point rather than the hotel. They email between 19:00 and 21:00 the night before with the details. **2.** Passport name, number and date of birth for both of you on their insurance form, which is required before the tour runs. Do both now. `reservations@thetripguru.com`.

Nimman in the evening

The café and craft-beer district west of the moat. Where Chiang Mai goes when it isn't being a temple town.

U Chiang Mai

November 6 — Friday

CHIANG MAI

Elephant Nature Park — Elephant Highlands, booked

Booking `55796` · two adults · THB 12,000 total. A genuine sanctuary: feeding and observing, no riding. **Hotel pick-up from U Chiang Mai between 08:00 and 08:45** — wait in the lobby, and check your name with the driver, because not every pick-up vehicle carries the park's logo. Vegan lunch, transport, admission, insurance and an English-speaking guide are included.

THB 8,400 in cash, on the morning

Only the **THB 3,600** deposit has been paid. The **THB 8,400 balance must be settled in Thai baht at the start of the trip** — not by card, not in advance. Draw it in Chiang Mai on the 5th. This is the largest cash requirement of the fortnight.

Confirm the pick-up point 72 hours ahead

If the park has not been told your pick-up point within 72 hours of the trip, you are expected to start from their office at 1 Ratmakka Road instead. `info@elephantnaturepark.org` or +66 53 272855.

It is a walking day, and a muddy one

Moderate to fit: mountainsides and slopes, up to **3½ hours** of walking, often muddy. A change of clothes and footwear is essential, plus a towel, hat, sunscreen, repellent and a refillable bottle — in **one small day pack each**, which is the whole baggage allowance.

Repack tonight

Tomorrow starts early — you are away from the hotel by about 06:00.

November 7 — Saturday

KRABI

FD3072 — Chiang Mai 07:55 → Krabi 09:55

Thai AirAsia, A320, non-stop. Booking `UYTUHF`. Roughly two hours in the air.

Krabi airport to Ao Nang

About 30 minutes.

Check in — Centara Ao Nang Beach Resort & Spa

Confirmation `2535573436` · 3 nights · Deluxe Room, 1 King, Pool Access. **You land well before check-in at 15:00** — leave the bags at reception and start on the beach. Two things to ask for on arrival: a room **away from the drainage canal** that runs between the wings, which is a recurring smell complaint, and confirmation of the pool-access room you paid for. Non-refundable; breakfast extra, around **THB 325–650** each.

First Andaman sunset

Afternoon on the sand, then a long seafood dinner.

November 8 — Sunday

KRABI

Island-hopping — not booked

A full day by boat: the **Hong Islands** lagoon, or the classic **4-Islands** route taking in Phra Nang cave beach, Tup, Chicken and Poda. Longtails leave from the Ao Nang beach pier, about ten minutes' walk. Book locally the day before.

The most weather-dependent day of the trip

Early-November seas are still unsettled and boat trips are the first thing cancelled. If it's rough, swap with tomorrow and do the inland day instead — that flexibility is the whole reason these two days sit next to each other.

Reef-safe sunscreen

Oxybenzone sunscreens are banned in Thai marine national parks.

November 9 — Monday

KRABI

Optional — **Tiger Cave Temple at sunrise**

1,260 steps to the summit shrine and a view over the whole Krabi plain. Brutal in the heat, which is the argument for going at dawn.

Optional — **Emerald Pool & hot springs**

Inland, in rainforest — a spring-fed pool the colour of its name and a set of warm cascades. The gentler alternative to the steps; easy afternoon back at the beach.

Long drive tomorrow

Repack tonight and keep one small bag accessible — you climb down stairs into a boat tomorrow and the big cases can stay at the pier office.

November 10 — Tuesday

KHAO SOK

Leave Krabi by 09:00

About **2 hours by road** to the 500Rai Pier Office at Chiew Larn. The private car is included in the resort package. Leave early enough for slack at the pier — you need to pay the park fee and get bags down to the boat before it goes, not arrive dead on the hour.

Longtail across Cheow Lan Lake — 12:00

About **1.5 hours**, sightseeing on the way, and the resort appears like a floating village under the karsts. Boats out to the resort leave the pier at **12:00 or 15:30 only**. Miss the 12:00 and you arrive after the sunset cruise below.

THB 340 each, in cash

The national park fee, payable on arrival and not included in the package. Bring it in cash.

Check in — 360° Issara Floating Resort

Booking `0592406` · 3 nights · the 3-Night Essence package, all-in. Check-in from 14:00. **Air-conditioning runs 12:00–06:00 only**, and that applies to all three nights.

Wildlife safari & sunset cruise — 17:00

Included. Swim off the deck first; set dinner is served over the water.

November 11 — Wednesday

KHAO SOK

Pakarang Cave Trail — 09:45

The one fixed thing today: a 1.5 km trek plus a bamboo raft. **THB 200 each, cash**, not included.

Then nothing at all

Kayak straight off your own balcony — every room has one. Swim in the fresh water, read, watch the light move across the karsts. This is the day the trip is built around.

November 12 — Thursday

KHAO SOK

Morning on the lake

Sightseeing along the shoreline — gibbons, hornbills, and elephants if you are lucky.

Prakai Petch Cave Trail — confirm this one

Swamp forest, small waterfalls and a glittering cave. The resort lists it as running **Mon / Wed / Sat**, and the 12th is a **Thursday** — so confirm it on arrival rather than counting on it. The morning lake trip above is the fallback.

Last sunset cruise — 17:00

Pack tonight

Check-out is 10:00 and tomorrow is the tightest day of the trip.

November 13 — Friday

KHAO SOK → BANGKOK

Check out 10:00, boat out at 10:30

This is the only scheduled boat back. It feeds a non-refundable flight the same afternoon, so reconfirm it with the resort the day before and don't plan on arranging something later.

Chiew Larn to Surat Thani

At the airport (URT) around 13:00, which leaves roughly three and a half hours in hand.

SL741 — Surat Thani 16:40 → Don Mueang 17:55

Thai Lion Air, arriving **Terminal 2**. Reservation code `OWUPXU`. Note this is **Don Mueang, not Suvarnabhumi**.

Into the city by rail, not road

Take the **SRT Red Line** to Krung Thep Aphiwat, then the MRT to Sukhumvit. It's a Friday and the roads will be at their worst; the train is elevated and ignores them. Reckon on being checked in around 19:00–19:30.

Check in — Grande Centre Point Terminal 21

Travelocity itinerary `73523066938869` · 1 night · Executive Suite for two. The hotel sits on top of the Asok interchange, so dinner is downstairs. Non-refundable.

November 14 — Saturday

BANGKOK → HOME

A half day, not a full one

Check out at 12:00 and leave the bags at the desk. You have about five hours, so keep it central — **ICONSIAM**, Jim Thompson House, a last massage. Not Ayutthaya; it needs the better part of a day.

Leave by 17:00 — and mind the airport

You arrived at **Don Mueang** yesterday but fly home from **Suvarnabhumi**. They are 50 km apart. From Asok it is one MRT stop to Phetchaburi and straight onto the **Airport Rail Link at Makkasan** — about 30 minutes, and no traffic to allow for.

EK373 — 20:45 to Dubai, then JFK

Suvarnabhumi 20:45 → Dubai, connecting to New York JFK at 08:15 Sunday. Booking `H2M5FJ`. At the airport by about 17:45.

Chok dee

Fourteen days, thirteen nights, five bases and four ways of travelling between them. Safe flight home.

Bookings & references

Every confirmed booking, in trip order. Name and reference are sufficient at check-in.

FLIGHTS — INTERNATIONAL

CONFIRMED · SEATS PURCHASED

Emirates

H2M5FJ Out 30 Oct · back 14 Nov

EK202 JFK 19:45 → Dubai · EK374 Dubai → Bangkok, arrives 07:35 on 1 Nov. Returning EK373 Bangkok 20:45 on 14 Nov → Dubai → JFK 08:15 on the 15th. Economy, both passengers, A380 on the Bangkok legs.

HOTEL — BANGKOK

CONFIRMED · PAID

The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok

90034653 1–3 Nov · 2 nights

Deluxe Room, 1 King Bed, Park View. Booked through Chase Travel (Trip 1027840438) under The Edit: breakfast for two daily, USD 100 property credit, welcome amenity, Wi-Fi, and upgrade / early check-in / late check-out subject to availability.

DINING — BANGKOK

CONFIRMED · PREPAID, NON-REFUNDABLE

Manohra Dining Cruises · Anantara Riverside

YQGNYS 1 Nov · 20:00 · 2 people

Premium set menu with free-flow wine and beer, THB 5,500 each. Booked through TableCheck; THB 11,000 charged in full. Departs the Anantara Riverside pier — free shuttle boat from Sathorn pier every 15 minutes. No dietary restrictions were advised. Confirm the boarding time: the published cruise leaves 19:30 with check-in 19:15.

RAIL — BANGKOK TO CHIANG MAI

TICKETED

State Railway of Thailand

34511470 3 Nov · 18:40 → 07:15

Special Express #9, two 2nd-class A/C sleeper berths. Krung Thep Aphiwat (KTW) to Chiang Mai (CGM), about 13 hours. E-tickets issued; be at the station by 18:10.

HOTEL — CHIANG MAI

CONFIRMED · NON-REFUNDABLE

U Chiang Mai

2535552787 3–7 Nov · room held from the 3rd

Deluxe with Bathtub, 1 King, two guests. Booked through Chase Travel (Trip 1027896876). The night of the 3rd is paid deliberately so the room is available on arrival at 07:15 on the 4th. Breakfast not included, about THB 399 each.

TOUR — CHIANG MAI

CONFIRMED · FREE CANCELLATION TO 24 H BEFORE

TripGuru Thailand · via Tripadvisor

1444673351 5 Nov · 08:30 · 2 adults

Doi Inthanon National Park, private full-day tour with an English-speaking guide. USD 250 paid in full. Includes hotel pick-up and drop-off, air-conditioned vehicle, water and entrance fees (park THB 300, Twin Pagoda THB 100); excludes lunch. TripGuru reference 7E51T410N0DP. Send them your WhatsApp number and hotel before 18:00 the previous day, and passport details for both travellers on their insurance form before the tour.

TOUR — CHIANG MAI

CONFIRMED · PART-PAID, BALANCE IN CASH

Elephant Nature Park

55796 6 Nov · pick-up 08:00–08:45 · 2 adults

Elephant Highlands, single-day visit. THB 12,000 total: THB 3,600 deposit paid, **THB 8,400 balance due in cash, in Thai baht, at the start of the trip**. Hotel pick-up from U Chiang Mai; confirm the pick-up point at least 72 hours ahead or start from their office at 1 Ratmakka Road. Vegan lunch, transport, admission, insurance and guide included. One small day pack per person.

FLIGHT — CHIANG MAI TO KRABI

CONFIRMED

Thai AirAsia

UYTUHF 7 Nov · 07:55 → 09:55

FD3072, Airbus A320, non-stop. Both passengers.

HOTEL — KRABI

CONFIRMED · NON-REFUNDABLE

Centara Ao Nang Beach Resort & Spa

2535573436 7–10 Nov · 3 nights

Deluxe Room, 1 King Bed, Pool Access. Booked through Chase Travel (Trip 1027898679). Check-in 15:00, check-out 12:00. Ask for a room away from the drainage canal. Breakfast extra, THB 325–650 each.

RESORT — KHAO SOK

CONFIRMED · TRANSFERS INCLUDED

360° Issara Floating Resort

0592406 10–13 Nov · 3 nights

3-Night Essence package, all-inclusive. Private car from Krabi and the longtail transfer are both included. Boats to the resort leave Chiew Larn at 12:00 or 15:30 only; the return boat is 10:30. THB 340 each in cash for the national park fee. A/C runs 12:00–06:00.

FLIGHT — SURAT THANI TO BANGKOK

CONFIRMED

Thai Lion Air

OWUPXU 13 Nov · 16:40 → 17:55

SL741, arriving Don Mueang (DMK) Terminal 2 — not Suvarnabhumi. Both passengers ticketed; check-in required.

HOTEL — BANGKOK

CONFIRMED · NON-REFUNDABLE

Grande Centre Point Terminal 21

73523066938869 13–14 Nov · 1 night

Executive Suite for two, on the Asok interchange. Booked through Travelocity. Check-in from 14:00, check-out 12:00. The card used to book must be presented at check-in with matching photo ID.